The phrasebook

108 idioms, bits of business jargon, and mangled metaphors from eight sketches.

Get everyone together

Circle the wagons [A]
Get everyone looped in [A]
Get on the same page [A]
Get our ducks in a row [A]
All hands on deck [A]
Get on board [V]
Pull on the same oar [V]
Work in tandem [A]
Put our heads together [V]

Keep the meeting going

Circle back [T]
Touch base [B]
Pick your brain [B]
Bend your ear [B]
Reach out [B]
Piggyback onto [T]
Bring you up to speed [C]
Give you the 411 [A]
Dovetail onto [V]

Start talking about talking

Get down to brass tacks [T]
Talk turkey [A]
Cut to the chase [T]
Draw a roadmap [A]
Start a dialogue [V]
Moving forward [J]
Float the idea [I]
Run that by someone [I]
Get your eyes on this [J]

Get something done, eventually

Take the lead [C]
Take the bull by the horns [A]
Get this off the ground [B]
Push the envelope [A]
Think outside the box [A]
Pound the pavement [A]
Right the ship [A]
Keep your eye on the ball [T]
Go hard or go home [A]

Sound strategically important

Drill down [A]
A granular approach [V]
Look at everything from 35,000 feet [V]
Peel the onion back [V]
Blue sky [V]
Ahead of the curve [V]
Bring to the table [A]
A game changer [J]
A power move [T]

The business vocabulary

Best practices [T]
Core values [V]
Intellectual capital [A]
Competitive advantage [A]
The bottom line [B]
Crunch the numbers [J]
Deliverables [B]
Brick and mortar [A]
B-to-B [A]

Selected from the eight sketches listed on page 2; not an exhaustive series or film transcript.
Phrases are lightly normalized for standalone reading. Caption wording can vary.
Click any phrase to open its episode near the relevant line. Letters identify episodes.

The phrasebook, continued

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Keep it efficient

Lean and mean [A]
Trim the fat [V]
Cost-effective [C]
Streamlined [A]
Top tier [A]
Peak performance [I]
Cost-saving measures [V]
Up and running [A]
On point [A]

Deal with the competition

Have them on the ropes [D]
Have the upper hand [D]
A fly on the wall [D]
A no-spin zone [D]
Smell blood in the water [A]
A wolf in sheep's clothing [I]
A Trojan horse [B]
Throw them off the scent [B]
The pump is primed [B]

Handle a problem

Drop the ball [A]
Run off the rails [A]
Fall on the sword [A]
Between a rock and a hard place [A]
A horse of a different color [A]
A fly in the ointment [V]
A bridge too far [J]
Above my pay grade [I]
Get caught with our pants down [B]

Proceed with caution

Let sleeping dogs lie [B]
Tread lightly [B]
Keep it on ice [B]
Table this [B]
Pull the rug out from under [I]
Ruffle the feathers [B]
Move the goalposts [A]
Let it sink in [D]
The eyeball test [J]

Wrap it up and do it again

Do a postmortem [A]
Debrief the situation [A]
Turn the page [J]
Cover a lot of ground [J]
Coming down the pike [B]
At the end of the day [T]
Until the cows come home [J]
The chickens are coming home to roost [J]
Our work is cut out for us [A]

The wonderfully mangled ones

Close it and hose it [A]
Punch the puppy [A]
Step on the duck [A]
Keep it linear [A]
Bricks and clicks [T]
Grease the pig [B]
The big hog in the walk [B]
Doggy dog culture [J]
Whale tail onto [V]

EPISODE KEY / SOURCE LINKS

C Conference Call
T The Torrance meeting / J.K. Simmons
A All Hands Meeting
B Bathroom
D Drive Thru
V Video Conference / Ferrell & Forte
I Troubleshooting
J Firing Jay / J Mascis

Sources: Funny Or Die uploads and English captions. Compiled 13 October 2026. Unofficial fan compilation.